Pascal's Triangle (1641)

$$\binom{n}{k} = \binom{n-1}{k-1} + \binom{n-1}{k}$$

- **Corollary**

Pascal's identity, together with the initial conditions $\binom{n}{0} = \binom{n}{n} = 1$ for all integers *n*, can be used to give a geometric arrangement of the binomial coefficients in a triangle, called Pascal's triangle, as follows:

$\binom{0}{0}$

$\binom{1}{0}\ \binom{1}{1}$

$\binom{2}{0}\ \binom{2}{1}\ \binom{2}{2}$

$\binom{3}{0}\ \binom{3}{1}\ \binom{3}{2}\ \binom{3}{3}$

$\binom{4}{0}\ \binom{4}{4}$

$\binom{5}{0}\ \binom{5}{5}$

$\binom{6}{0}\ \binom{6}{6}$

$\binom{7}{0}\ \binom{7}{7}$

$\binom{8}{0}\ \binom{8}{8}$

(a)

1

1 1

1 2 1

1 1

1 1

1 1

1 1

1 1

(b)

